

Part E: Cyber Security Awareness Poster:

PHISHING AND PHISHING ATTACKS

Don't Take the Bait. Stay Aware, Stay Secure.

Phishing is a type of cyber attack where criminals pretend to be a trusted person or organization to trick you into revealing sensitive information such as usernames, passwords, credit card details, or OTPs. It is one of the most common and dangerous online threats.



WHAT IS PHISHING?

Phishing is a social engineering attack in which attackers send fake emails, messages, or create fake websites that look real, to steal your personal and financial information.

HOW PHISHING ATTACK WORKS



1. Attacker sends a fake email or message.
2. The email contains a link or attachment to a fake website.
3. You are tricked into entering your information.
4. Attacker steals your information and misuses it.

COMMON EXAMPLES

- Email Phishing**
Fake emails that look like they come from banks, companies, or trusted organizations.
- Spear Phishing**
Targeted attacks on specific individuals or organizations using personalized information.
- Smishing (SMS Phishing)**
Fake text messages that contain malicious links to steal your data.
- Vishing (Voice Phishing)**
Fraudulent phone calls that trick you into sharing sensitive information.
- Pharming**
Redirecting you to fake websites even if you type the correct URL.

SIGNS OF A PHISHING ATTACK

- Unexpected emails or messages
- Urgent or threatening language
- Requests for personal information
- Suspicious links or attachments
- Spelling and grammar mistakes
- Emails not addressed to you properly
- Sender's email address looks unusual
- Too good to be true offers or rewards



REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

You receive an email that looks like it's from your bank. It says your account will be locked unless you verify your details. You click on the link, enter your username and password on the fake website, and later you find out your account has been hacked.



From: support@yourbank-secure.com
To: you@example.com
Subject: Urgent: Verify Your Account

Dear Customer,
We detected unusual activity in your account. Please click the link below to verify your identity and avoid account suspension.

[Verify Now](#)

Thank you,
Your Bank Security Team

HOW TO PROTECT YOURSELF

- Don't click on suspicious links or attachments.
- Never share personal or financial information.
- Check the sender's email address carefully.
- Ensure the website uses HTTPS and is genuine.
- Use strong passwords and enable two-factor authentication.
- Keep your software and antivirus updated.
- Stay informed and aware about phishing tactics.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Phishing attacks rely on tricking you, not hacking your device. Always think before you click!

Be Alert. Be Safe. Be Secure.

WHAT TO DO IF YOU ARE A VICTIM

- Change your passwords immediately.
- Contact your bank or service provider.
- Report the incident to the authorities.
- Scan your device for malware.

REPORT PHISHING

Report suspicious emails to your email provider and report cyber crimes at www.cybercrime.gov.in

